All-hands meeting notes

Follow-up planning call for the UvA researchers' AI course, Friday 16 October 2026

Who	Gjorgji, Joaquim, Marleen and Stefan, who joined online. Possibly Marc as well. The transcript does not separate speakers, so attributions below follow context.
Source	Recording and transcript in this folder, plus the auto-generated summary.
Status	Notes written from the transcript. Items marked to confirm were garbled or ambiguous in it.

Summary

The team dropped the collective Anthropic license. Participants buy their own subscription and charge it to a dedicated cost number. Setup comes in three forms: the Windows script, a Mac script that Gjorgji uploads today, and a manual leaflet for machines where scripts fail. The participant email goes out on Sunday. Evening 1 now includes privacy and safety, which moves up from evening 2. Evenings 2 and 3 are outlined. Lean is parked for the end of evening 3, and only if there is interest.

Decisions

- **Bring your own subscription.** A team plan was judged infeasible and legally awkward, since a formal contract would have covered participants. Everyone buys their own and charges the cost number. This replaces the collective-or-individual question left open on 8 October.
- **Three ways to set up.** A PowerShell script for Windows, a script for Mac, and a written leaflet for doing it by hand. Someone suggested downloading from the Claude website instead, but the team kept the script because it also installs VS Code, the Python packages, the virtual environment and the permissions file.
- **Participants make their own Claude account.** The script cannot do that. If they already have an account they are logged in, otherwise they get a link to register. One month of Pro was mentioned. Earlier notes said three months, to confirm.
- **Stuck participants get a partner.** About 20 percent of machines are expected to fail, either because people do not understand the script or because the machine is an outlier. Those people sit next to someone whose setup works, so the lecture does not stall.
- **Privacy and safety move to evening 1.** The group preferred being ethical from the start, ahead of Marleen's exercise.
- **Lean goes to the end of evening 3.** The team shows it only if enough people are interested. See the evening 3 section for the reasons.

Action items

Owner	Action	When
Gjorgji	Upload the Mac setup script to the GitHub repository	Today
Gjorgji	Send the finished scripts and the repo link by email to whoever mails the participants	By Sunday
Gjorgji	Extend the evening 1 slides: ethics and safety (20 to 30 minutes, one exercise), prompt injection, proprietary data, journal AI policies	Before evening 1
Gjorgji	Package the evening 2 files (codebook and per-folder agent file) into the repo	After they arrive next week
Organiser (Marc or Joaquim, to confirm)	Email participants: how to buy a subscription, the cost number, software instructions, which paper to pick	Sunday
Marleen	Write the paper selection criteria, two sentences, for the email	Before the email

Owner	Action	When
Evening 2 lead (to confirm)	Send the evening 2 files to Gjorgji	Next week
Stefan	Turn the evening 3 outline into slides	Before evening 3

Setup and participant email

- The script installs Claude Code, VS Code and the course Python packages, and creates the virtual environment with the permissions file. Participants only sign in to Claude.
- It has run on a UvA-managed Windows machine, on a Windows machine the university does not manage, and on Gjorgji's Mac. It has not run on a UvA-managed Mac yet. UvA laptops are all managed to some degree, through Microsoft registration and pushed updates, so some problems are expected.
- Gjorgji gives the script and repo link to the person sending the email. Whoever sends it copies the other, because people reply anyway.
- Someone warned that a mixed group, like the MBA and minor students, will ask what a script is and how to run it. The instructions need to explain that.
- Participants pick one paper before evening 1. It should be a theoretical paper with policy implications. It is used later for the article exercise and is described for a journal.

Evenings

Logistics

- Room 402. Sessions run from 18:00 to 21:00, with sandwiches from 17:30. Helpers can arrive from 17:00, to confirm.
- Every evening takes at most three hours. Ending after two or two and a half is fine.
- Food is arranged. Someone has already asked how many people attend.

Evening 1: introduction, organisation, ethics, article exercise

- The organiser opens with a short introduction: why the course exists and what each evening covers.
- Gjorgji follows with research organisation. What does working with Claude mean for your files, your machine and your thinking? The existing 30 minutes stay as they are, including skills and permissions.
- Then 20 to 30 minutes on ethics and safety with one exercise, showing an allowed and a blocked resource. It also covers how journals treat AI submissions, consent for personal data, prompt injection, NDAs and data from statistics offices, how to ask for permission, and how a leak happens. As one speaker put it, there is no data source you may upload by default.
- Gjorgji shows the terminal and shell calls live and asks participants to follow along. Every time an agent asks permission, they should know what it means.
- Marleen and her partner then run the exercise on turning a formal paper into a popular article.

Evening 2: library tool and deep research

- Participants write a paper on the impact of AI on the university, covering research and education. They use two assistants, one for deep research and one built on a tool that searches the university library database.
- The tool is an API, so each participant needs some API credit. The speaker had read that every Claude user gets $100 of free credit. Whether that applies to participants is to confirm.
- Participants write something themselves and compare it with what the tools produce. Verification is the point.
- Files arrive next week and Gjorgji packages them into the repo. They include a codebook and an agent file for the folder.

Evening 3: replication and theory research

- Paper replication comes first. The chosen paper contains an econometric model, so participants practise replicating it. Skills come up here as well, since replication work streamlines well with the right ones.

- Stefan then presents. The first two parts are high level: why mathematics is not simply solved, and where AI has a comparative advantage. The third part is three types of theory research, each based on a model he has built and solved. He then follows the audience's interest into his own research.
- His main lessons. Get the prompt right, because 20 pages of correct calculation is useless to a reader until someone asks the model to find the key idea and rebuild the proof around it. Revisit old PhD problems that were too hard to compute, such as a fifth-order polynomial that now takes half an hour. Generate many derivations and look for patterns, the way an experimental scientist does. In one project he read 80 pages of rough notes, found a pattern and wrote a paper from it.
- Lean stays at the end. Writing a problem in Lean is hard, it pulls attention from agentic AI, and no economics journal accepts a certificate without human intuition. It can also confirm a result that is wrong because the assumptions you entered were wrong.
- Stefan expects to join online. All the others plan to be in the room, because exercises always throw up problems.

Open questions

- Does the script work on a UvA-managed Mac?
- Who writes the manual leaflet? Nobody took it.
- Who sends the participant email, and who is in copy?
- Is it one month of Pro or three, and does the $100 API credit apply to this group?
- Can helpers get into room 402 from 17:00?
- Who owns the evening 2 files and the evening 2 exercise?

The transcript has one speaker label throughout, so attributions follow context. The auto-summary misspells names and terms, among them Georgie, Joachim and Lint for Lean. Personal and social remarks from the end of the call are left out on purpose. Check names and owners before sharing.